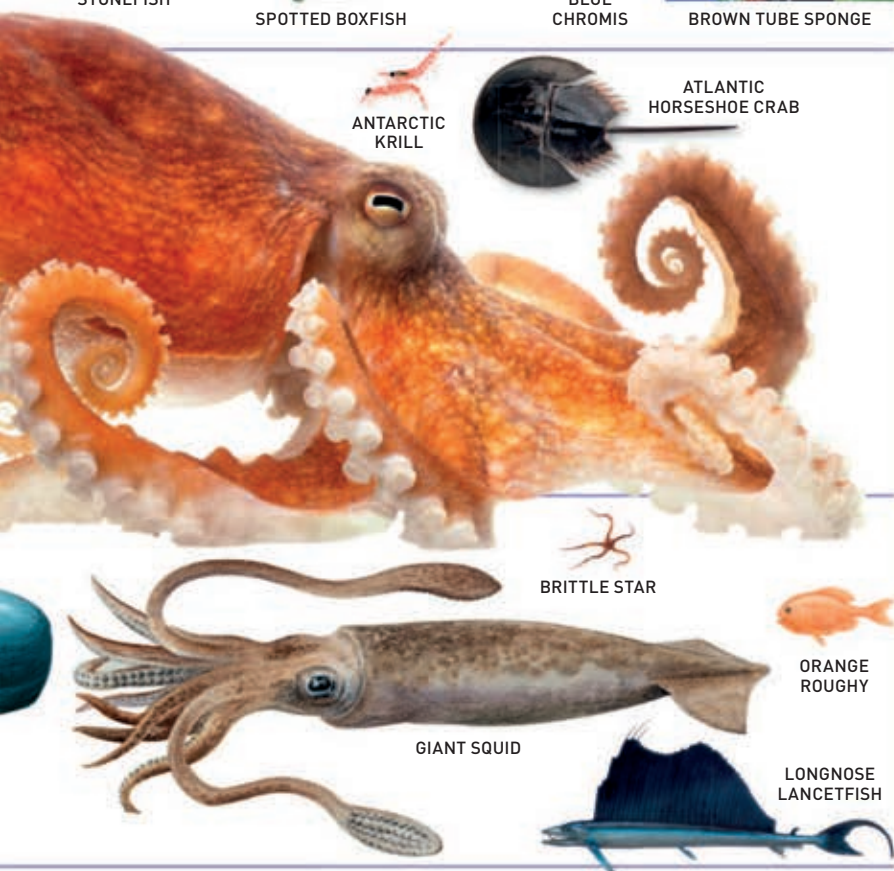
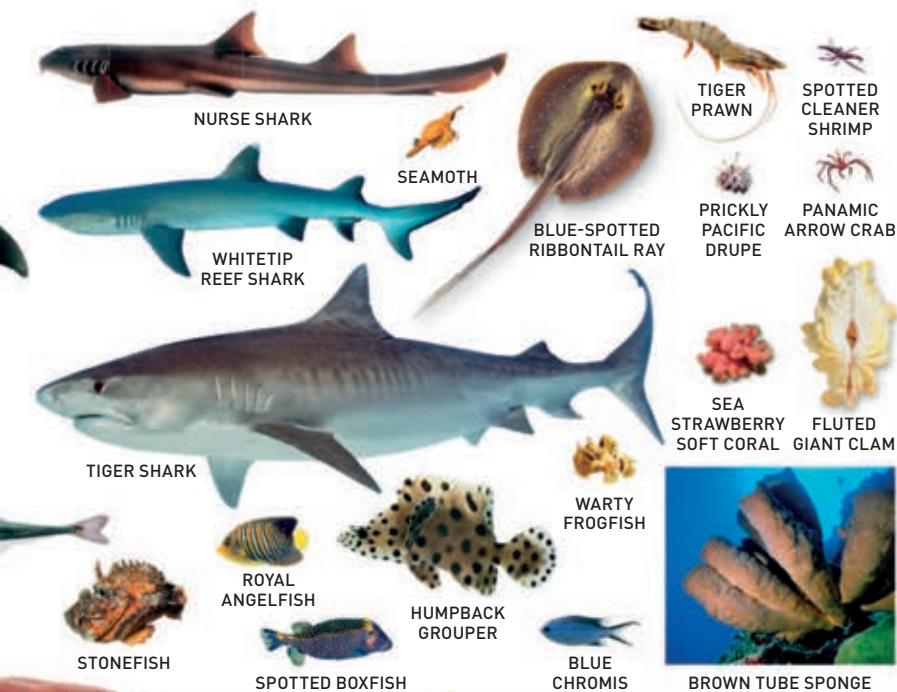
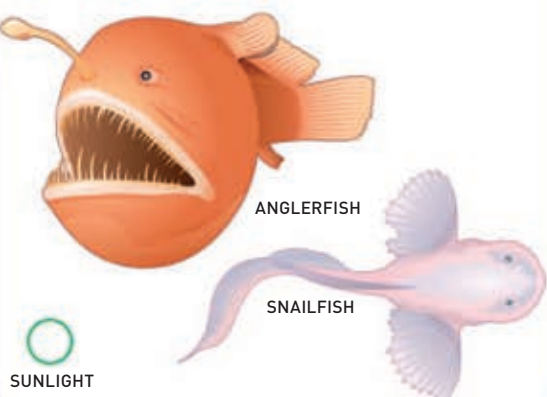




HADAL ZONE

In some places, deep ocean trenches plunge deeper than the ocean floor. Some animals live in this zone, but very little is known about them.



SUNLIGHT

Ocean

The oceans form the biggest environment for wildlife on the planet. Most organisms live near the sunlit surface, especially in shallow water near land, where the water is rich in food. But some animals are able to live in the ocean depths, where there is no light and very little to eat.

WHERE ON EARTH?

The five interconnected oceans cover more than two-thirds of the planet. The biggest ocean is the Pacific, while the smallest is the Arctic Ocean at the North Pole. The Atlantic extends all the way from the Arctic to the Southern Ocean around Antarctica. All the oceans, whether cold or warm, are teeming with life.



ANIMAL RELATIONSHIPS

The oceans are full of dangers, so some animals join forces to improve their chances of survival. Others tag along with larger animals to feast on scraps of food that their big partners ignore.



CLOWNFISH AND ANEMONE

The stinging tentacles of a big sea anemone do not affect the clownfish, but they protect it from predators.



MANTA RAY AND REMORA FISH

A sucker on its head allows the remora to cling to big fish, like this manta ray, as they cruise the oceans.



BOXER CRAB AND ANEMONES

This tiny tropical crab holds a stinging sea anemone in each claw. It uses them for defence, and to stun prey.

GROUPS OF FISH

Many open-water fish travel in big groups called shoals or schools. Some contain thousands of fish. Living together like this makes it difficult for big hunters such as sharks to pick out individual fish.



BLACK SMOKERS

In some of the deepest parts of the ocean, water seeps into the ocean floor and is heated by hot volcanic rock. The hot water forms a spring on the ocean floor, which erupts. As the hot water hits the cold sea, the minerals turn into solid particles that build up to form smoking "chimneys" up to 55 m (180 ft) high. Amazingly, there are unique animals, including some tubeworms, that can survive this extreme heat.

